

Connecting a brand

How a brand is set up and how its sales reach Pluggz · 21 August 2026

In one paragraph

Every Pluggz link already carries a reference that is unique to the individual click, and that reference already arrives on the brand's website on every visit we send them. The only piece a brand has to add is one message coming back the other way, saying an order completed. There are two ways to send it, and which one suits them depends entirely on what their shop is built on.

Part one: what we do

The five steps, in order. Steps 1 to 3 take about ten minutes.

1. Add the brand	Admin, then Brands, then Add a brand. The question that matters is what their shop is built on, because it decides what we hand them at the end.
2. Take what it gives you	Saving the brand issues its credentials. A Shopify shop gets a snippet with its key already inside; anything else gets a key and a signing secret. The secret is shown once and never again. Copy it there and then.
3. Add their products	Admin, then Products, then Add products. Paste the address of a product page and the name, picture and price are read off it. Repeat for each product.
4. Send it to the brand	Forward part two of this document along with their key. Send the signing secret separately and never by email or WhatsApp.
5. Test it together	One real order, for a small amount, before anything is announced. Part three.

Two things to get right before any real money moves

Set the commission rate to the agreed figure. A brand added without one carries a placeholder, and every sale recorded against it will be split at the wrong rate. Rates are frozen against each sale as it is recorded, so correcting this afterwards does not fix the sales already taken.

Check the product address opens. Paste it in a browser. A good number of shops answer only on the www version of their name and not without it, and a link built from the wrong one leads nowhere at all.

Part two: for the brand

This part can be forwarded as it stands.

When a shopper follows a Pluggz link to your shop, they arrive with two extra values on the address:

`yourshop.com/products/whatever?ref=pluggz&pz=cmsnwhf8z0001ks24dkvv7df1`

That **pz** value identifies the single click that sent them. Keep it, and send it back to us when the order completes. That is the whole mechanism.

Which route suits you

	Shopify pixel	Server call
Who sets it up	The shop owner	A developer
How long	About five minutes	An hour or so
Can it be blocked	Yes, by ad blockers and privacy settings	No
Can it be proved	No, it is signed by nothing	Yes, signed with your secret
How sales appear	Marked unverified, checked against your orders	Trusted

We would rather you took the server call. Take the pixel if a developer is not available, because a pixel reporting most of your sales is worth far more than a perfect integration that never gets built.

Route A: the Shopify pixel

Nothing here touches your theme or your checkout, and it can be removed at any time from the same screen.

- In the Shopify admin, open **Settings**, then **Customer events**.
- Click **Add custom pixel** and name it Pluggz Affiliate Tracking.
- Under Customer privacy, set **Permission** to Required.
- Set **Data sale** to: data collected does not qualify as data sale.
- Paste the snippet we sent you into the code box.
- Click **Save**.
- Click **Connect**. Saving alone does not switch it on.

It should read **Connected** when it is live. Permission is set to Required because this is marketing and analytics tracking and UK GDPR applies, which means a shopper who declines your cookie banner is not tracked and their order is not attributed. That is a legal requirement rather than a fault.

Route B: the server call

Two steps: keep our reference, then tell us when the order completes.

Step 1: keep the reference

When a visitor arrives with **pz** on the address, store it against their session or cart for 30 days. Almost nobody buys on their first visit, and without this the reference is gone by checkout.

Step 2: tell us when the order completes

POST <https://pluggzofficial.co.uk/api/track/sale>

Header		Value
X-Pluggz-Key		Your key, the one beginning pz_live_
X-Pluggz-Signature		HMAC SHA256 of the exact bytes of the body, using your signing secret, as hex
Content-Type		application/json
Body field		
pz	required	The reference you kept from step 1
orderRef	required	Your own order number
value	required	In pence, as a whole number. 49.99 is sent as 4999
currency	optional	Defaults to GBP
soldAt	optional	ISO date. Defaults to now

Things worth knowing

- Sign the exact bytes you send, not a re-serialised copy of the object, or the signature will not match.
- Sending the same order twice is safe. It is recorded once and the second call answers with the same sale.
- A **200** with a saleId means it landed. A **401** is the key or the signature, a **422** means we do not recognise that pz, and a **400** means a field is missing or the value was not a whole number of pence.

Part three: test it once, together

Do this before anything is announced. It takes about ten minutes and it is the only way to know the whole chain works end to end.

Where the test link comes from

A tracking link is created the moment a creator puts one of the brand's products on their storefront. There is one for every product on every creator, and it is the same link a shopper follows. Nothing separate has to be generated for a test.

To find one: **Admin**, then **Products**. Search for the product, and the **Tracking link** column gives it. The copy button beside it puts the full address on your clipboard, ready to paste.

<https://pluggzofficial.co.uk/go/qjdqqkfm>

If the column says None, no creator has plugged that product yet, so no link exists. Ask a creator to add it, or add it to a creator's storefront yourself.

Then, in order

- Send the brand that link and ask them to open it in a normal browser. They should check that **pz** arrives on their product page and that their site keeps it.
- They place one real order for a small amount, in that same browser.
- Open **Admin**, then **Record sales**. The order should appear within a minute, against the right creator, with the commission already split.
- Remove the test order afterwards so it does not sit in anybody's figures, and reset the click count on that link.

If nothing appears, the useful question is which half failed. A click recorded against the link means our side worked and the order message never arrived, which puts it on the brand's side. No click at all means the shopper never followed the link we think they did.

What happens to a sale after that

Stage	What it means
Pending	Recorded. The brand's return window has not passed yet
Verified	The return window has passed, so the refund risk is over
Paid to Pluggz	The brand has settled their invoice
Paid to creator	Paid out, on the 1st or the 15th

Commission is split at the moment the sale is recorded, at the rates in force that day, and frozen against it. A rate change later never rewrites what a creator has already earned.

What the brand gets out of it

A dashboard of their own showing clicks, sales and what they owe, so the conversation is about the same numbers on both sides; commission paid only on sales that survived the return window; and no spreadsheets going back and forth at the end of the month.